CHRISTMAS BUDGET KIT

Decide the total first. Then spend the season calmly - every gift, party and trip inside one number you chose on purpose.

START HERE - HOW THIS KIT WORKS

1. Set your total first (p.2). One number for the whole season, chosen before you spend anything.
2. Split the total into seven caps: gifts, party & food, travel, decorations, cards & postage, giving, and everything else.
3. List the gifts before you shop (p.3-4) - one cap per person, so nobody gets forgotten or overspent on.
4. Write spending down as you go (p.5). Two honest minutes after each shop, not a January surprise.
5. At the sales, use the 24-hour rule (p.7). If it was not on your list, it waits a day.
6. In January, look back once (p.9) - the real numbers, and three things to carry into the new year.

THE ONE RULE

The total comes first. Caps can move between categories - the total doesn't. If a page in this kit doesn't help you keep the total, skip the page.

WHAT'S INSIDE

p.2 Holiday Budget at a Glance - the total and the seven caps
p.3-4 Gift List Planner - 40 people, a cap for each
p.5 Holiday Spending Tracker - every purchase, as it happens
p.6 Party & Food Budget - menu, shopping, hosting extras
p.7 Black Friday & Sales List - planned buys only, with the 24-hour rule
p.8 Everything Else Budget - travel, cards, decorations, giving
p.9 January Look-Back - the season in numbers, and a clean start

Print at 100% (actual size). Print just the pages you need - the gift list and the tracker are made to be reprinted. Black & white throughout, easy on home ink.

Holiday Budget at a Glance

One page holds the whole season: your total, the cap for each part of it, and how much of each cap is already spent.

MY TOTAL HOLIDAY BUDGET

$ _____

Decide this number first - before the first purchase.

Category	Cap $	Spent so far $	Still left $
Gifts			
Party & food			
Travel			
Decorations			
Cards & postage			
Giving			
Everything else			
TOTAL			

HOW TO KEEP THIS PAGE TRUE

Once a week, add up the tracker (p.5) and update the "Spent so far" column. Two minutes, once a week - that is the whole system.
Caps can move between categories. The total doesn't.

Gift List Planner

Everyone you are buying for, one line each - with a cap per person, set before you shop.

Person	Gift idea	Cap $	Actual $	Bought	Wrapped
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐

PAGE TOTALS caps $ _____ actual $ _____

Gift List Planner (continued)

More people, same rule: a name, an idea, and a cap for each.

Person	Gift idea	Cap $	Actual $	Bought	Wrapped
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐

PAGE TOTALS caps $ _____ actual $ _____

Holiday Spending Tracker

Every purchase, written down the day it happens - gifts, food, travel, all of it. This page feeds the totals on p.2.

Date	What I bought	Category	Planned $	Actual $

Running low in one category? Move a cap on p.2 - don't borrow from the total.

Party & Food Budget

For the meal (or meals) you are hosting: the menu, the shopping, and the little extras that quietly add up.

PARTY & FOOD CAP (from p.2) **$** _____ Guests coming: _____

THE MENU

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____

SHOPPING LIST

Item	Budget $	Actual $

HOSTING EXTRAS - the quiet add-ons

- ☐ Drinks $ _____
- ☐ Ice & paper goods $ _____
- ☐ Extra seating & tableware $ _____
- ☐ Music, games & candles $ _____

Black Friday & Sales List

Sales are where good budgets go quiet. List what you planned to buy at a discount - before the sale starts.

THE 24-HOUR RULE

If it wasn't on this list before the sale, it waits 24 hours. Still want it tomorrow - and it still fits the cap? Then it's a plan, not an impulse.

Store	Item	Was $	Sale $	Planned	Impulse
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐
				☐	☐

Before you check out: total this page, then check it against your caps on p.2.

Everything Else Budget

The spending that isn't gifts or the party: travel, cards, decorations, giving. It all comes out of the same total.

TRAVEL

	Budget $	Actual $
Fuel & tolls		
Flights, trains & stays		
Food on the road		

CARDS & POSTAGE

	Budget $	Actual $
Cards		
Stamps & postage		
Wrap, ribbon & tags		

DECORATIONS

	Budget $	Actual $
Tree		
Lights & candles		
Table & home		

GIVING

	Budget $	Actual $
Charity donations		
Teacher & service gifts		
School & community		

January Look-Back

Once, in January, with a cup of something warm. Ten minutes - then this page becomes next year's head start.

THE SEASON, IN NUMBERS

My total cap was **$** _____

I actually spent **$** _____

The difference **$** _____ (under is a win. Over is information.)

WHAT SURPRISED ME - the spending I didn't see coming

WHAT WORKED - worth doing again

THREE THINGS TO CARRY INTO JANUARY

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

A NEW YEAR STARTS ON THIS PAGE

With the real numbers, not a guess. Keep this page with the kit - it is the first page of next year's calmer season.